

Brothers on Opposite Teams at the World Cup -- Who Does Mom Cheer For?

From: BBC News Mined: 2026-06-20 3 min read

What if you and your sibling both made it to the **World Cup** but on different teams? That's real life for Desire and Guela Doue. The brothers grew up in Angers, France, with a French mom and an Ivorian dad. Now Desire, 21, is a star for **Paris Saint-Germain** and plays for France. Guela, 23, plays for **Strasbourg** and chose **Ivory Coast**. They tell each other everything and are super close. But on June 30, they could face off in Texas if both their teams finish second in their groups. Imagine your brother trying to score against you! In a **friendly match** earlier this month, **Ivory Coast** beat France 2-1, but Desire didn't get to play. Guela said, "It's a shame I didn't get to play against my brother, but I'm happy, and he isn't too fed up." They're not the only ones. There are four sets of brothers at this **World Cup** playing for different nations. Remember the **Boateng brothers**? Jerome played for Germany and Kevin-Prince for Ghana they faced each other in 2010 and 2014. Now it's the Doues' turn. So, who will their parents cheer for? Probably both and hope for a tie!

Word Treasure

Paris Saint-Germain -- A famous and wealthy soccer team based in Paris, France.

Strasbourg -- A French soccer club from the city of Strasbourg, which is smaller than Paris Saint-Germain.

Ivory Coast -- A country in West Africa, also known by its French name Côte d'Ivoire.

Boateng brothers -- Two famous soccer-playing brothers--Jerome played for Germany while Kevin-Prince chose Ghana.

friendly match -- A soccer game that does not count for a tournament, often used for practice and trying out players.

World Cup -- The biggest international soccer tournament, held every four years with teams from all over the world.

Background you need

The World Cup is the most-watched soccer tournament, held every four years, and players often represent their country of birth or their parents' homelands.

Ivory Coast (a country in West Africa) has produced many talented players who also play for European clubs like Paris Saint-Germain (a top French team) and Strasbourg.

It is not unusual for brothers to end up on different national teams; the Boateng brothers--Jerome for Germany, Kevin-Prince for Ghana--faced each other at the 2010 and 2014 World Cups.

Break it down

WHO: Brothers Desire Doue (France) and Guela Doue (Ivory Coast).

WHAT: They could face each other in a World Cup match if their teams both finish second, continuing a rare soccer tradition.

WHERE: A possible match in Texas, USA.

WHY: They chose different national teams because of their mixed heritage, creating a special family story.

Why it matters

It shows that families can love and support each other even when they are on different sides in sports, which is like when you and a friend play on opposite teams but stay friends.

Test what you remember

1. Where did Desire and Guela Doue grow up?

- ☐ (A) Paris
- ☐ (B) Strasbourg
- ☐ (C) Angers
- ☐ (D) Texas

2. Which team does Desire play for?

- ☐ (A) Strasbourg
- ☐ (B) Paris Saint-Germain
- ☐ (C) Ivory Coast
- ☐ (D) Angers

3. Which country did Guela choose to play for?

- ☐ (A) France
- ☐ (B) Germany
- ☐ (C) Ivory Coast
- ☐ (D) Ghana

4. Where could the brothers face off if both teams finish second in their groups?

- ☐ (A) New York
- ☐ (B) Texas
- ☐ (C) California
- ☐ (D) Florida

5. In the friendly match earlier this month, who won?

- ☐ (A) France 2-1
- ☐ (B) Ivory Coast 2-1
- ☐ (C) It was a tie
- ☐ (D) The game was cancelled

6. Which other set of brothers played for different nations in 2010 and 2014?

- ☐ (A) The Doue brothers
- ☐ (B) The Boateng brothers
- ☐ (C) The Williams brothers
- ☐ (D) The Silva brothers

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: C 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. Soccer fans:** They love the drama of brothers competing against each other, and it makes the World Cup more exciting and memorable.
- 2. The Doue family:** Their parents are probably very proud of both sons, even though it can be a little awkward when one has to lose.
- 3. Purists of the game:** Some might say players should only represent one country, but the rules allow choosing a parent's homeland, and both brothers are honoring their roots.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):